IT265 Game Design Treatment

Student submission

Assignment revision: 6 | Maximum points: 10 | Student: jrm236 | Submitted: 2026-10-26T01:27:33.075Z | Submission revision: 64 | Receipt: v4r_01M5TX3SYK4N4DHFB67ANN0A04 | Exported: 2026-10-26T01:27:39.387Z

Worksheet link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/it265-game-design-treatment/jrm236

Grading link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/it265-game-design-treatment/grading/jrm236

AI disclosure: Completed; 1 entry; 0 declared AI use; 1 declared no AI use; policy v1

Game Concept And Mechanics

Working title

Response prompt

Give a working title and explain why it fits your game. Mention alternatives only if useful.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The title choice is connected to the game's concept. (up to -0.25 points)

Submitted response

The current title for my game is "Mist Marchers". The name itself comes from the general lore and setting of my game. It origina from how, in the world, a mysterious brackish red mist has slowly begun to spread throughout the world, transforming those wh come into contact with it. As the mist expands, different factions enter the affected areas for their own reasons, whether to dest study, or take advantage of the chaos that comes from it.

The word "Marchers" is used to refer to the small exploration groups controlled by each unit as they move throughout these reg The battles in the game represent the encounters that take place within the mist between the different factions or beings from t mist. Because each faction isn't necessarily allied with one another, these encounters can lead to conflict. The title is intended represent both the setting and structure of the game.

Setting and premise

Response prompt

Describe the game's setting, theme, and the player's role or characters. Explain the story or situation that frames play; a game without a story can describe its premise.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The setting, theme, and player role form an understandable premise. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

My game takes place in a dark-fantasy setting that has begun to experience the strange appearance of a mysterious brackish r mist that unpredictably transforms those who come into contact with it into different monsters. People and animals turned by th begin to act more like an infection, swarming the surrounding area in hordes, aiming to inflict others with the disease.

Different groups have developed their own response to the appearance of the mist and are not necessarily allied with one anot each faction has its own goals for how to either harness or destroy the upcoming threat. Players must choose one of these fact and command a small group of three units that represent their faction's unique identity.

Player goals

Response prompt

Explain what the player is trying to achieve, what stands in the way, and how success, failure, or the end of play is determined.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The goal, challenge, and end conditions let a reader understand the intended outcome of play. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

The game is a two-player competitive tactical skirmish game. Each player begins with three units belonging to their chosen fac
Units are divided into three different tiers, with each one representing their strength in ascending order, with Tier 1 units being t
weakest and Tier 3 being the strongest. The objective is to eliminate all of the opposing player's units. Players must manage th
units' positions and health by using a regenerating action-point resource each turn. Terrain can interfere with movement and at
while each unit's statblock determines how far they can move, how difficult they are to hit, and how much damage they can dea

Each faction also has a special ability tied to a limited resource. Players begin with a total of three of this resource and can spe
only once per turn. These points don't regenerate, meaning the player can only use their faction's ability a maximum of three ti
a game, allowing for thoughtful decision-making for the player as they can either save these resources or use them to potential
an advantage.

Core gameplay loop

Response prompt

Describe a typical turn or repeated interaction: what the player chooses or does and how the result changes the next decision. Game state means the current situation, such as positions, resources, or score.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The repeated player actions and resulting state changes explain how the core gameplay loop works. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

At the start of each turn, players receive three Action Points (AP). These points can be spent to activate units, and the cost dep
on the tier of the unit. Creating a choice between activating one's weaker unit multiple times or spending all AP to activate your
stronger units for the turn. When a unit is activated, the player can move it according to its movement value and attack an oppo
unit if the target is within its range. Once an attack is initiated, the player must first roll a D6 to determine the accuracy of the at
The result of the roll is compared to the Armor Value (AV) of the opposing unit, with the roll needing to be higher than the unit's
the attack is successful, the attacker can then roll the damage dice listed on the attacking unit and deal damage to the target's
the total. Throughout this process, the players constantly need to decide which unit is the best to activate for the turn, where th
should move, who should be targeted, and whether or not they should use an FP to activate their ability. After the current activ
player has spent their AP or chooses to end their turn, the turn moves to the opposing player.

First physical prototype

Response prompt

Describe your planned physical prototype, including its play area and pieces or materials, such as a board, cards, tokens, dice, or a score sheet. Explain what the pieces represent and how a player uses them to try the core gameplay loop. A finished prototype or playtest result is not required here.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The plan identifies the prototype's pieces or materials and explains how they support its core gameplay loop. (up to -0.25 points)

Submitted response

The physical prototype should use a 6x6 grid for the main playing area. Each player should have three unit tokens and their respective cards, with each one representing a tier. These tokens must be placed on the board according to the chosen level selected by the players.

Once a level card is drawn, the players must place the terrain tokens in their respective areas. Other than this, each player mu
have dice to facilitate combat and other calculations. For example, each player would have a 1 D4, D8, as well as 2 D6 and 3 D
all, the D4, D8, and 1 of the D6s would be used for calculating damage of attacks; The other D6 would be for calculating accura
comparison to the opposing unit's armor; Lastly, the D20s should be there to keep track of the health of each player's unit, with
players changing the number on the top of the dice to represent the unit's current health. Additionally, the players will have 3 sm
dice, which will serve the simple purpose of representing the amount of faction abilities each player currently has.

Audience And Access

Target audience

Response prompt

Identify the intended players, their relevant interests and play habits, and why the concept and play experience should appeal to them.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The intended audience and relevant interests or play habits are identified. (up to -0.5 points)
- The proposed game experience is connected to that audience with a reasoned explanation. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

The game is intended for players who enjoy competitive tactics games, tabletop skirmish games, different factions, and customization. The usage of only three units is intended to make the game easier to understand than other larger-scale wargar as well as shorter, while still giving players several decisions to make each turn. Each player has to only manage three units, b differences in their tier, positioning, terrain, and their faction ability can create multiple ways to approach a turn. Players who er experimenting with different playstyles may also enjoy how each faction is designed around a different strategy. For example, c faction titled the Fungal Crusaders focuses on using slower and tanker units, with their faction ability allowing them to heal and reduce the damage of the next attack taken, while other factions go down the route of needing to swarm around the enemy for bonuses through their faction ability.

Accessibility and inclusivity

Response prompt

Explain concrete ways players with different abilities can perceive, understand, and use the physical game, and how those choices can carry into the later digital version without losing the intended gameplay.

Requirements and potential deductions

- Specific accessibility and inclusion considerations are tied to actual game interactions. (up to -0.5 points)
- The response explains how the proposed choices preserve play and can inform the digital version. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

The game will avoid using color only to communicate any important gameplay info. Unit tiers, stats, terrain, and other meaningf will be able to be identified through text and symbols. This is especially important because the board will contain several differe units and terrain at the same time. Each unit should have a corresponding Unit Card that should use large, readable text and s to keep info such as the unit's Health, Move Speed, Armor Value, and Damage range easily found and understandable. The gr structure of the game also helps make movement and range calculation easier for the players to understand because they can easily counted.

USP, Pitch And Visuals

Unique selling points (USP)

Response prompt

Identify your game's unique selling points (USP): the distinctive design choices that give intended players a reason to choose it. Explain these through a relevant comparison with an existing game.

Requirements and potential deductions

- Concrete design differences explain the game's appeal to intended players compared with a relevant existing game. (up to -1 points)

Submitted response

This game takes inspiration from multiple different tactical RPGs and other tabletop games such as Final Fantasy Tactics, Warhammer 40K, D&D, and Trench Crusade, but combines different aspects from these games to create a smaller and more f format. In particular, the gameplay loop and abilities are inspired by the ones seen in FFTactics and D&D; the theme and idea players choosing one playable faction with their own unique identity rather than a mix of several different ones comes from Warhammer and Trench Crusade. The main difference between this game and those it was inspired by is that the game is mor focused on emulating a similar experience but in a faster way. Keeping the feeling of a tactical tabletop game while still keeping

scale small and manageable.

Concept pitch

Response prompt

Write a concise pitch that brings together your concept, intended audience, player experience, and strongest USP. Summarize your earlier answers rather than repeating their full details.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The pitch clearly communicates the concept, audience, intended experience, and strongest USP. (up to -1 points)

Submitted response

My game is a competitive two-player tactics skirmish game that combines the ideas from different tactical RPGs and tabletop g into a smaller and faster format. Players choose a faction with its own unique identity, units, and abilities, then control three of t on a 6x6 grid. Each turn, players must decide how to spend resources such as Action Points to activate units to move and atta others, as well as position them around terrain for a potential tactical advantage. The game is intended for players who enjoy ta decision-making in games such as Final Fantasy Tactics, D&D, and Warhammer 40k, but want to experience it in a more comp form. Rather than controlling large armies of minis in lengthy matches, players must focus on utilizing the three units they contr each with unique stats and their faction's special ability bolstering them further. Each faction encourages a different strategy, w the smaller grid battlefield puts players in the position of constant conflict with one another. The main goal of this design is to k the feeling of a tactics tabletop game while reducing its scale to be easier to set up, understand, and play in a shorter time fram

First sketch or storyboard panel

Image evidence prompt

Upload one readable sketch or storyboard image showing the game's concept, style, space, or player interaction. Add a caption explaining what it represents.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The sketch or storyboard panel makes one important part of the game concept understandable. (up to -0.5 points)
- The image and caption connect its visual choices to the game's theme or player experience. (up to -0.5 points)

Caption: This first image showcases the physical prototype of my game. In the image, you can see the 6x6 playing area and 6 different player tokens on opposing sides of the board. This showcases the general layout of the game, currently without any of the external pieces such as dice and terrain pieces. Additionally, the grid clearly shows each space the units can occupy. For the digital version of the game, this would still take aspects but would be greatly simplified in terms of visuals.



Second sketch or storyboard panel

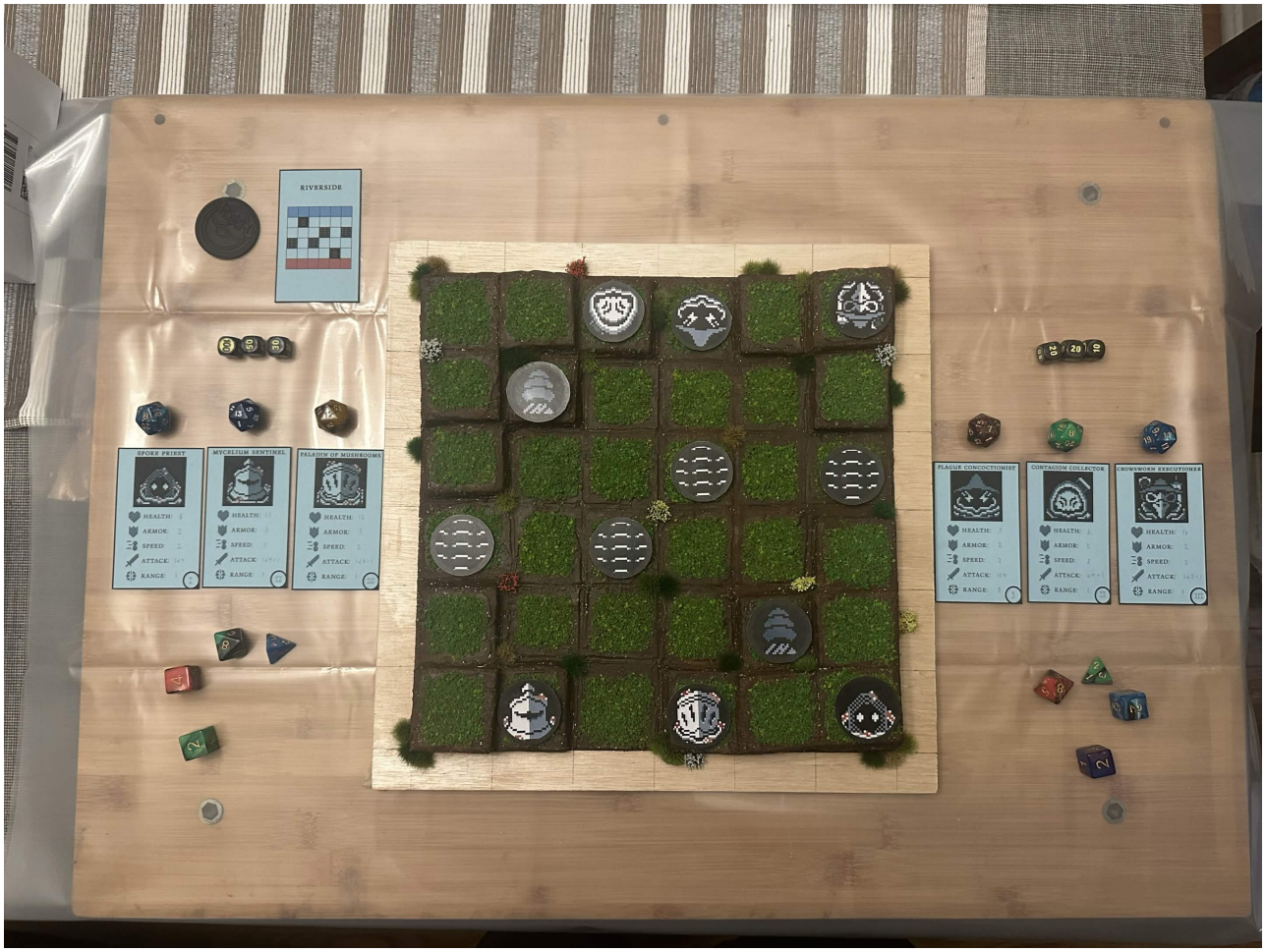
Image evidence prompt

Upload one different readable sketch or storyboard image showing another part of the game's concept, style, space, or player interaction. Add a caption explaining what it represents.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The second sketch or storyboard panel adds distinct information about the game concept. (up to -0.5 points)
- The image and caption connect its visual choices to the game's theme or player experience. (up to -0.5 points)

Caption: The second image is a more updated version of my game. In the image, you can see similar aspects such as the grid and player tokens, but there are multiple new additions to help with tracking, calculation, and strategy. For example, on the main grid there are new pieces added other than the player units; these are terrain pieces which have different effects on combat, such as decreasing the damage of ranged attacks or disallowing movement through the space. Following this, you can also see in the top left corner that there is a level card; these cards can be selected by players before they begin to dictate what stage they will be fighting on. On the card itself, you can see it shows the terrain placements as well as the spawn zones for both sides. Moving on, you can also see multiple dice and cards adjacent to the game board. The cards are unit cards, which dictate the different stats each unit has, such as their health, armor, damage, tier, etc. Above these cards are D20, which are used as a visual tracker to keep track of the current health of each unit. Above those are three smaller dice; these dice are used to track how many faction abilities a player has remaining. The dice under the cards are used for damage and accuracy calculation, with the pool consisting of one D4, D8, and two D6s, one of which is for damage and the other is for calculating the accuracy of an attack. Lastly, the coin in the top left is used to determine who goes first or helps with determining the outcomes of certain faction abilities. All of these added aspects provide much-needed info to help players understand and keep track of the game.



External Feedback

Feedback 1

Response prompt

Record feedback from person 1, using a different person for each feedback task and preferably someone in the intended audience. Give initials or a first name and their relationship to you, summarize a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style, and explain a revision or next test prompted by it.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The feedback provider and their relationship are identified without private contact details. (up to -0.2 points)

- The feedback reports a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style. (up to -0.3 points)
- A revision or next test follows from this feedback. (up to -0.2 points)

Submitted response

One person who helped playtest my game was my brother. He noticed some imbalanced parts of the game, such as the range attacks on specific units being very powerful and that one of the faction abilities wasn't as powerful as the others. To answer th removed ranged attacks from the tier 1 units and instead limited them for the higher tiers. I also strengthened the faction ability horde, which can increase the damage of their next attack against a target with two or more horde units adjacent to it, to now d the need for two or more units if there is only one horde unit left on the field. This should make that faction stronger, as their wh gimmick was to swarm the opposing team; the new change now gives the added effect of putting the last unit into a last stand- situation.

Feedback 2

Response prompt

Record feedback from person 2, using a different person for each feedback task and preferably someone in the intended audience. Give initials or a first name and their relationship to you, summarize a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style, and explain a revision or next test prompted by it.

Requirements and potential deductions

- A different feedback provider and their relationship are identified without private contact details. (up to -0.2 points)
- The feedback reports a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style. (up to -0.3 points)
- A revision or next test follows from this feedback. (up to -0.2 points)

Submitted response

Another person who gave feedback was a friend. They noticed that when I was brainstorming the mechanics of the game, I ma game board size 5x5; they mentioned that this size might not be sufficient for what I want to do. So I did some testing after, and agreed that the 5x5 board was too small, as it allowed the units to immediately run to the other side in one action and didn't lea lot of space for placing down terrain tokens. After increasing the board size, the game now feels a lot more open and strategic the positions available on the board.

Feedback 3

Response prompt

Record feedback from person 3, using a different person for each feedback task and preferably someone in the intended audience. Give initials or a first name and their relationship to you, summarize a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style, and explain a revision or next test prompted by it.

Requirements and potential deductions

- A third distinct feedback provider and their relationship are identified without private contact details. (up to -0.1 points)
- The feedback reports a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style. (up to -0.3 points)
- A revision or next test follows from this feedback. (up to -0.2 points)

Submitted response

Another friend mentioned potential problems with the action point system and how it might be too limiting or not allow for much strategy. After testing it, I determined that the action point system itself could have problems with balance and limiting actions, heavily depended on the stats of each unit. For example, I tested the move speeds of each unit and found that the tier 1 units b faster and also having a decently high health pool made the game feel like you should only activate the tier 1s instead of the ot units. After making some changes to the stat spreads and making the tier 1s generally weaker, I found that the action point sys does actually work well, so I decided to keep the current system.